

they began to save one-tenth of their income every week. One day they went shopping with money in their pockets and found out this great truth of merchandising: merchants sell for less when they sell for cash.

In addition, the husband felt more relaxed and confident now that he was out of debt and also had a backlog of money. This helped him in his job. He was called in for an interview, during which his employer asked him casually if he saved money in any of the local banks (just another way of asking "Do you save money?") The young husband's confident and affirmative answer was the right answer, and he got a promotion which led to greater things. Saving is an index of character for it has much to do with a man's sense of purpose and his ability to manage his affairs.

I once helped a man start saving even though he said it was absolutely impossible for him to do. First we set up a goal. It was the purchase of a handsome sport jacket, a sensible purchase in that he could wear it in his business as well as during leisure hours. The price, which would not buy an equivalent jacket these days, was \$24.95.

Then I made this fellow set down every cent he spent for two weeks. We went over the list together. The conversation went something like this:

"Can you give up two packs of cigarettes a week?"

"Yes."

"Instead of spending fifteen cents a day on a shoeshine, will you spend a dollar on shoe-shining equipment and shine your own shoes? And get a better shine for perhaps two cents?"

"Yes."

"Will you spend no more than one dollar on your lunch?"

"No, I eat with people who like to eat heartily and . . ."

I told him about a lunch I had had with Henry Ford. I ordered a lobster salad for three dollars. The billionaire ordered a sandwich and his total bill was eighty-five cents. Mr. Ford was not an eccentric about economizing. He was just a big enough and peaceful enough man to feel he could eat what he wished.

The man who could not save now said with determination: "I'll keep my lunch check down to one dollar. Yes!"

"Well, by saying *Yes* three times you've saved yourself at least ten dollars a week."

"Ten dollars a week!" He was astonished, then thoughtful. Without my having to oversee the process, he got himself out